

Yushi Sugimoto

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Division of Language and Culture
Graduate School of Humanities
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Research Syntax
Interests Computational Neurolinguistics

Employment

2024- Associate Professor (Lecturer), The University of Osaka
2022-2024 Project Researcher, The University of Tokyo

Education

2018-2022	PH.D. in Linguistics	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor
2016-2020	DOCTORAL PROGRAM [WITHDRAWN]	Sophia University
2014-2016	M.A. in Linguistics	Sophia University
2010-2014	B.A. in English and American Literature	Keio University

Grants, honours & awards

2025-2028 JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (S) (23H05493)
Explorations into the Neurocognitive Basis of Symbolic Processing: Focusing on the Mediation System between Form and Meaning of Human Language
Hiromu Sakai (PI)

2025-2028 JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists (25K16284)
A neuro-computational research on syntactic processing in the brain
Yushi Sugimoto (PI)
¥4,680,000 (Direct Cost: ¥3,600,000, Indirect Cost: ¥1,080,000)

2022-2026 JSPS Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C) (22K00609)
Theoretical and Demonstrative Research on Variation of Defectiveness of Sentence Structure and Locality of Movement
Nobu Goto (PI)

2022 Rackham Humanities Research Fellowship University of Michigan
2021 John D'Arms Faculty Award Graduate RA University of Michigan
2017-2018 Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows (17J03420)
2017-2018 JSPS Overseas Challenge Program for Young Researchers (201780049)

Publications & Talks

JOURNAL ARTICLES

- 2025** Alan Ke, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto, “Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding,” *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory*, 2025, [All authors equally contributed to this work]. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-025-09662-8>.
- 2024** Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeonjeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki, “Localizing Syntactic Composition with Left-Corner Recurrent Neural Network Grammars,” *Neurobiology of Language*, vol. 5, no. 1, pp. 201–224, Apr. 2024. doi: [10.1162/nol_a_00118](https://doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00118).
- 2023** Yushi Sugimoto and Acrisio Pires, “A parameter-free underspecification approach to complementizer agreement,” *Revista Linguística*, vol. 18, no. 1, pp. 62–81, 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.31513/linguistica.2022.v18n1a56350>
- 2022** Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista, “A late-insertion-based exoskeletal approach to the hybrid nature of functional features in creole languages,” *Languages*, vol. 7, no. 2, 2022, issn: 2226-471X. doi: [10.3390/languages7020092](https://doi.org/10.3390/languages7020092).
- 2021** Yushi Sugimoto, “Labeling defective T,” *Studia Linguistica*, vol. 75, no. 1, pp. 150–164, 2021. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1111/stul.12154>.

BOOKS

- 2023** Noam Chomsky, T. Daniel Seely, Robert C. Berwick, Sandiway Fong, M. A. C. Huybregts, Hisatsugu Kitahara, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto, *Merge and the Strong Minimalist Thesis (Elements in Generative Syntax)*. Cambridge University Press, 2023. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009343244>

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- 2025** Ryo Yoshida, Shinnosuke Isono, Kohei Kajikawa, Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki, “If attention serves as a cognitive model of human memory retrieval, what is the plausible memory representation?” In *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, Wanxiang Che, Joyce Nabende, Ekaterina Shutova, and Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, Jul. 2025, pp. 9795–9812, isbn: 979-8-89176-251-0. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.acl-long.483/>.
- Ryo Yoshida, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki, “Investigating psychometric predictive power of syntactic attention,” in *Proceedings of the 29th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning*, Gemma Boleda and Michael Roth, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, Jul. 2025, pp. 407–418, isbn: 979-8-89176-271-8. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2025.conll-1.27/>.

- 2024** Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto, and Yushi Sugimoto, “When the grammar doesn’t mind which merge it chooses,” in *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, Robert Autry, Gabriela de la Cruz, Luis A. Irizarry Figueroa, Kristina Mihajlovic and Tianyi Ni and Ryan Smith, and Heidi Harley, Eds., 2024, pp. 61–70.
url: <http://www.lingref.com/cpp/wccfl/39/abstract3617.html>.
- Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki, “JCoLA: Japanese corpus of linguistic acceptability,” in *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)*, Nicoletta Calzolari, Min-Yen Kan, Veronique Hoste, Alessandro Lenci, Sakriani Sakti, and Nianwen Xue, Eds., Torino, Italia: ELRA and ICCL, May 2024, pp. 9477–9488. url: <https://aclanthology.org/2024.lrec-main.828>
- 2022** Andrew McInnerney and Yushi Sugimoto, “On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects,” in *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America*, vol. 7, May 2022, p. 5207. doi: 10.3765/plsa.v7i1.5207.
- Savithry Namboodiripad, Nicole Cuneo, Mathew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Felicia Bisnath, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg, “Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in english,” in *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2022, pp. 1087–1093.
- 2021** Takanobu Nakamura and Yushi Sugimoto, “Apparent de re construals of de se anaphor in Japanese,” in *Proceedings of 28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics*, Oct. 2021.
- 2018** Yushi Sugimoto, “Move-agree or agree-move? on the movement theory under free merge,” in *Proceedings of 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*, Aug. 2018.
- 2017** Yushi Sugimoto, “Not so hyper: A-movement beyond clause boundaries?” In *Proceedings of 12th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*, Sep. 2017, pp. 273–280.
- 2016** Yushi Sugimoto, “De-phased by external pair-merge of c to t and its consequences,” in *Proceedings of The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe XXIV*, Dec. 2016, pp. 237–253.
- 2015** Yushi Sugimoto, “Pair-merge as free merge,” in *Proceedings of the 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar. Case and Agreement in Minimalism*, Aug. 2015, pp. 491–510.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2025** Itsuki Hamada, Yushi Sugimoto, Yohei Oseki, Michiru Makuuchi, and Hiromu Sakai. 2025. Neural correlates of prediction in language comprehension: An MEG study on Japanese classifier-noun processing. The International Symposium on Brain Function and Cognition (ISBFC): Neural Codes of Language and Action. Tokyo, Japan. September 9, 2025.

Ryo Yoshida, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Investigating Psychometric Predictive Power of Syntactic Attention. The 29th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning (CoNLL 2025). August 1st, 2025.

Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Exploring spatial and temporal dynamics of language comprehension in the brain with CCG. The 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci). Marriott Marquis, San Francisco, USA. July 31st, 2025 [*co-first authors] [poster]

Ryo Yoshida, Shinnosuke Isono, Kohei Kajikawa, Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. If Attention Serves as a Cognitive Model of Human Memory Retrieval, What is the Plausible Memory Representation? The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL2025). July 30th, 2025.

Yushi Sugimoto. 2025. Modeling Syntactic Composition in the Brain with Computational Models. Sophia University Linguistic Society. July 19th, 2025. Tokyo, Japan. [invited]

Shinnosuke Isono*, Kohei Kajikawa*, Yushi Sugimoto*, Masayuki Asahara, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. Modeling Japanese EEG data with CCG. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2025), Nagasaki, Japan, March 13th, 2025. [theme section] [*co-first authors]

Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2025. BCCWJ-MEG: A novel Japanese MEG dataset. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2025), Nagasaki, Japan, March 12th, 2025. [poster]

2024 Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Akitake Kanno, Masatoshi Koizumi, and Yohei Oseki. 2024. Investigating Syntactic Attention in the brain. Society for the Neurobiology of Language 16th Annual Meeting, Brisbane, Australia, October 24-26, 2024. [poster]

Yushi Sugimoto. 2024. Boxing and Remnant Movement. SMOG & ANU International Conference on Syntax and Semantics (ICSS2024), Andong National University, Southern Korea, August 20, 20-024. [online] [Invited]

Taiga Someya, Yushi Sugimoto, Yohei Oseki. 2024. JCoLA: Japanese Corpus of Linguistic Acceptability. LREC-Coling 2024. Lingotto Conference Centre, Torino, Italia, May 25-30, 2024.[poster]

2023 Acrisio Pires and Yushi Sugimoto. 2023. A Parameter-free Underspecification Approach to Complementizer Agreement. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [LSRL53], June 29th, Paris, France.

Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2023. A Novel Feature of the complementizer system in Cabo Verdean Creole. The 53rd Linguistic Symposium on Romance Languages [LSRL53], June 29th, Paris, France.

Yushi Sugimoto, Ryo Yoshida, Hyeojeong Jeong, Masatoshi Koizumi, Jonathan R. Brennan, and Yohei Oseki. 2023. Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar. Annual Meeting of the Association for Natural Language Processing (NLP2023), Okinawa, Japan, March 16th, 2023. [poster] [proceedings in Japanese]

2022

Savithry Namboodiripad, , Felicia Bisnath, Nicole Cuneo, Matthew A. Kramer, Yourdanis Sedarous, Yushi Sugimoto, and Adele Goldberg. 2022. Backgroundedness predicts island status of non-finite adjuncts in English. The 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Metro Toronto Convention Centre, Toronto, Canada, July 30th, 2022.

Alan Ke, Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Lack of c-command in coordinate structures: Evidence from binding. 45th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW45], Queen Mary University of London, April 28th, 2022. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution] [Acceptance rate 11% (24 out of 213)]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2022. Privileges of the Rich. The 46th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC46], March 19th, 2022. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andrew McInnerney, and Sugimoto, Yushi. 2022. On dissociating adjunct island and subject island effects: syntactic vs. extrasyntactic approaches. The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022], Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Yushi Sugimoto and Marlyse Baptista. 2022. On the nature of the hybrid grammar of creole formation: a case study of functional features. The 96th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2022], Washington D.C., January 6th, 2022 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19]

2021

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Adding a locus of variation as underspecification. Workshop on Linguistic Variation at the Interfaces II, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, November 18th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. When the grammar doesn't mind which Merge it chooses. The 39th meeting of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, [WCCFL39], hosted by The University of Arizona's Department of Linguistics, April 11th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andreas Blümel, Nobu Goto and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Options of Externally Merging {v, T, C} — a Comparative Approach. The 45th Penn Linguistic Conference [PLC45], March 20th, 2021. [online oral presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Andrew McInnerney, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2021. Subject Islands in a Simplest Merge System. The 95th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2021], January 9th, 2021 [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, equal contribution]

Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. Where does the ‘self’ come from? A de se binding approach to zibun in Japanese. 28th Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference [JK28], September 16th, 2020. [online poster presentation due to COVID-19, second author]

2020 Yushi Sugimoto. 2020. A dynamic process in forming structural backbone of creole languages. The 94th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America [LSA2020], New Orleans, January 3th, 2020. [poster]

2018 Takanobu Nakamura, and Yushi Sugimoto. 2018. Long distance relativisation and phasal transfer of KP. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Association of Great Britain [LAGB]. University of Sheffield, UK. September 14th, 2018 [poster, second author].

2017 Yushi Sugimoto. 2017. Move-Agree or Agree-Move? On the movement theory under free Merge. The 13th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics [WAFL13]. International Christian University, Japan, May 27th, 2017. [poster]

2016 Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. Not so Hyper: A-movement Beyond Clause Boundaries? Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics 12 [WAFL12]. Central Connecticut State University, US, May 14th, 2016. [poster]

Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phasing Effect: External Pair-Merge of phase head and non-phase head. 39th Generative Linguistics in the Old World [GLOW39], Linguistics in Göttingen, Germany, April 6th, 2016. [poster], Abstract published in GLOW Newsletter #76, 176-178.

Yushi Sugimoto. 2016. De-Phased by External Pair-Merge of C to T and Its Consequences. The Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe [ConSOLE XXIV], The University of York and York St. John University, UK, January 8th, 2016.

2015 Yushi Sugimoto. 2015. Pair-Merge as Free Merge. The 17th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar [SICOGG17] at Kyung Hee University, Seoul, Korea, August 5th, 2015.

TALKS

2025 Current Issues in Minimalism : GK, MC and beyond? Keio Linguistic Colloquium, Keio University, Tokyo, Japan, 05/10-11, 2025 [Invited]

2024 Modeling Syntactic Composition in the brain with Small/Syntactic Language Models, talk at Hiromu Sakai’s lab meeting, Waseda University, Japan, 11/05/2024

2023 Modeling Japanese fMRI data with left-corner Neural Network Grammar, Setagaya Linguistic Circle, Tokyo, Japan, 06/03/2023

Recombination of Functional Features: A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to Creoles (with Marlyse Baptista), Penn Syntax Lab meeting, Pennsylvania, US, 04/07/2023. [online]

A fresh view of SMT [Review of Chomsky's talks at KEIO-EMU lecture series] Keio study group on generative grammar, Tokyo, Japan, 03/22-23/2023 [online]

BCCWJ-MRI/MEG. AI Yotta International Symposium. Tohoku University, Sendai, 03/10/2023 [online]

Merge of Functional Heads: A Theory of Amalgamation (with Andreas Blümel and Nobu Goto), Tohoku University, Sendai, Japan, 02/12/2023 [Invited]

2022 A Late-Insertion-Based Exoskeletal Approach to the Hybrid Nature of Functional Features in Creole Languages, 10/01/2022 Keio Linguistic Colloquium, Tokyo, Japan [online] [Invited]

MISCELLANEOUS WORK

2022 Underspecification and (im)possible derivations: Toward a restrictive theory of grammar. Ph.D Thesis, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor Committee: Acrisio Pires (co-chair), Marlyse Baptista (co-chair), Richard L. Lewis, Terje Lohndal

Teaching

2025-	Psycholinguistics, graduate course	The University of Osaka
2024-	Integrated English	The University of Osaka
2023	Intermediate/Advanced Syntax	Keio University
	English communication I/II	Tokyo University of Agriculture
2017	Industrial English	Tokyo Polytechnic University

Skills

Python (Nilearn, MNE-Python, Eelbrain)

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